



CAESAR, STABBED TO DEATH BY 60 SENATORS, FELL AT THE FOOT OF THE STATUE OF POMPEY, HIS FORMER ENEMY.

The Roman Empire had begun! For the next 500 years, Rome was ruled by emperors.

Rome, city of marble

Augustus once said of Rome, "I inherited it brick and left it marble." He meant that he had rebuilt many of the public buildings, facing them with marble, as well as paving public squares with marble. He wasn't alone. Many of the emperors who came after him stamped their own identities on the city, erecting ever grander buildings and monuments.

At the heart of Rome was the Forum—a rectangular space that became the political, commercial, religious, and social center of the

entire Roman world. The Forum was surrounded by government buildings, law courts, and temples. Politicians gave speeches from platforms in the Forum, listened to by crowds of Roman citizens.

To the west of the Forum lay the Campus Martius (Field of Mars), where the earliest gladiator fights were staged.

UNDER THE NEW NAME AUGUSTUS, OCTAVIAN BECAME THE FIRST ROMAN EMPEROR. HIS RULE BROUGHT PEACE TO THE ROMAN WORLD.

